

of the Buddhist art and architecture that flowered during the Silla Kingdom.

Pre Rup Temple

Location Siem Reap, Cambodia

The majestic temple-mountain of Pre Rup, consecrated to the Hindu god Shiva in around 961 CE, was the state temple of the Khmer King Rajendravarman II. The pyramid-shaped structure is square in layout

and has two enclosing walls: an outer wall, measuring around 384 ft by 417 ft (117 m by 127 m), with *gopurams* (gateway towers), and an inner wall. Long halls, now derelict, line the inner enclosure. At the heart of the complex, five sanctuary towers are set on a square base—four at the corners of the square and the fifth, raised on an upper tier, at its center. Stairways on each side of the base, flanked by lion statues, lead to the upper levels. Brick and laterite (a red clay), the primary building materials used at Pre Rup, lend a warm, reddish hue to the compound.

Brihadisvara Temple

Location Thanjavur, India

Dedicated to the Hindu god Shiva, the Brihadisvara Temple is a masterpiece of southern Indian Dravidian architecture. Completed in about 1010 CE at the height of the Chola dynasty (10th–13th centuries). The huge complex is enclosed by a colonnaded *prakara* (veranda), with a 98-ft- (30-m-) high *gopuram* (gateway tower) to the

east and smaller *gopurams* around the perimeter. Above the inner sanctum, its central tower, or *vimana*, rises to a height of around 200 ft (60 m) and, like the rest of the temple, is built entirely of granite and covered with intricate carvings. A massive statue of Nandi—the sacred bull ridden by Shiva—carved from a single piece of granite and weighing around 28 tons (25 tonnes), faces the sanctum. The temple is still in use.

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